ASSEMBLY POLLS 2023

CONGRESS

WHY THE CONGRESS NEEDS INDIA NOW

THE LOSSES IN THE HEARTLAND STATES ROB THE GOP OF ANY HEFT IN THE I.N.D.I.A. BLOC. THE ALLIANCE HAS TO REGROUP, FIND A FRESH STRATEGY TO TAKE ON THE BJP IN 2024

By **KAUSHIK DEKA**



SOUTHERN SAVE
Rahul and Priyanka Gandhi with Telangana Congress chief Revanth Reddy during a poll campaign roadshow in Malkajgiri, Nov. 28

On December 3, as news of the Congress rout in the assembly elections in the three heartland states of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh started drifting in, party president Mallikarjun Kharge called for a meeting of the partners of INDIA, or the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance, on December 6. The coalition of 28 Opposition parties was formed in June this year for the grand project of fighting the BJP collectively in the summer of 2024. This meeting was supposed to resume the stalled process of brainstorming and perhaps initiate discussions on a key pending issue: seat-sharing. Instead, the call for the meeting exposed the growing fault lines within the bloc, as allies challenged the central role the Congress has been trying to assert.

That there was little coordination among the allies was evident soon enough: less than 24 hours before the meeting was to take place, it was deferred to the third week of December. Trinamool Con-